

The site sells your surf photos and takes payment automatically. This guide covers the big picture: what each page does, how a sale flows from click to download, where the money lands, and how to handle the handful of customer questions you'll actually get.

● THE PAGES AT A GLANCE

● Home

The front page. Shows your **Featured** photos and points people to the gallery and booking.

● Gallery

Where customers **buy**. Every photo is watermarked here; they add the ones they want to the cart.

● Book a Session

Your packages & pricing for hiring you to shoot. Leads come through Contact.

● Cart & Checkout

Customer reviews picks, enters email, and pays through **Stripe**. No account needed.

● HOW A PHOTO SALE WORKS

1

Browse Gallery

Watermarked previews

2

Add to Cart

\$5 each · 5 for \$20

3

Pay via Stripe

Card, enters email

4

Order Recorded

Saved automatically

5

Gets Photos

On-screen + email

Pricing is automatic. The cart charges **\$5 per photo**, or **5 photos for \$20** (the discount applies on its own once they hit 5). You don't set prices per photo.

● WHAT THE CUSTOMER RECEIVES

A

A success page, right after paying

Shows their photos with **Download** buttons for the full-resolution, watermark-free files.

B

A confirmation email with the same download links

Sent automatically so they can download later, even if they close the tab. The email tells them to keep it.

● STRIPE — WHERE THE MONEY LIVES

Stripe is the payment processor. Every card payment, payout to your bank, and refund happens in the Stripe Dashboard at dashboard.stripe.com.



Payments

Dashboard → **Payments** lists every sale: amount, customer email, and date. Each one links to its details.



Payouts

Stripe automatically deposits your balance to your bank on a rolling schedule (Dashboard → **Payouts**). Nothing to do — just confirm your bank is connected.



Refunds

Open the payment → **Refund**. You can refund the full amount or part of it. The customer gets their money back in a few days.

Test mode vs. Live mode. Stripe has a toggle (top of the Dashboard). **Live** = real money. If a test purchase didn't charge a real card, you were in Test mode. Make sure the site runs on **Live** keys when you're truly selling.

● ORDERS — YOUR RECORD OF EVERY SALE

Beyond Stripe, every paid order is saved in your **Sanity Studio** at waterdogproductions.com/studio → **Orders**. This is your quick reference for who bought what.



Each order shows

Customer email, which photos they bought, the amount paid, the date, and a **status**.

Q What the statuses mean

→ **Paid** they paid, links are active · **Fulfilled** optional — you marked it handled · **Refunded** money returned, downloads cut off

Refunding? Do both steps. Refund the payment in **Stripe**, then open that order in **Orders** and set its status to **Refunded**. That second step is what **disables their download links** so a refunded customer can't keep grabbing the files.

● CUSTOMER SERVICE — THE COMMON QUESTIONS

Most messages fall into a few buckets. Here's the quick fix for each. Your support address is

mehlerc12@gmail.com .

Q "I paid but didn't get an email."

→ First have them check **spam/junk**. Confirm the sale in **Stripe** → **Payments** (or **Orders** in Studio). If it's real, the fastest fix is to **email them the photos directly**: open each photo in Studio, download the original, and send it.

Q "My download link won't work / I lost it."

→ Links can expire from their inbox or get mangled. Confirm the order, then **send the original files directly** from Studio (as above). This always works and needs no link.

Q "I want a refund."

→ Refund in **Stripe**, then mark the order **Refunded** in Studio so the links stop working. Use your judgment on partial vs. full.

Q "Which photo is mine? / Can you find my order?"

→ Search **Orders** by their **email**. It lists exactly which photos they bought and what they paid.

Q "The photo still has a watermark."

→ They're looking at the **gallery preview**, not their purchased file. The watermark-free version is behind the **Download** button on the success page / email.

Q "Do you do custom shoots?"

→ Point them to **Book a Session** for packages, and have them reach out via **Contact**.

● THE ONE MOVE THAT SOLVES MOST ISSUES

Send the originals directly. If anything goes sideways with links or email, you can always open the customer's photos in **Studio**, download the full-resolution originals, and email them yourself. Confirm they actually paid (Stripe or Orders) first — then deliver. Done.

● WHEN TO LOOP IN BRIAN

● Site is down / errors

Checkout won't load, gallery is blank, or a customer reports an error page.

● Payment looks wrong

A charge for the wrong amount, a duplicate, or a dispute/chargeback in Stripe.

● EMAILING PAST CUSTOMERS

Every photo buyer's email is saved in **Stripe** → **Customers** (and in **Orders**). To send announcements or deals to past customers, use **Resend** — it's already set up for your emails.

1

Get the list

In **Stripe** → **Customers**, click **Export** to download a CSV of your buyers' emails.

2

Build an audience in Resend

At **resend.com** → **Audiences**, create a list and import that CSV.

3

Send a Broadcast

Resend → **Broadcasts** → write your email (new galleries, seasonal deals), pick the audience, and send. Free for up to **1,000 contacts**.

Email rules (CAN-SPAM). Only email people who actually bought from you, always keep the **unsubscribe link** (Resend adds it automatically), and honor opt-outs. Never buy or scrape email lists.

● GETTING PAID FOR SESSIONS

For booked shoots (Dawn Patrol, Full Session, Epic Day), collect payment through the same Stripe account — no QuickBooks needed. Two options:



Payment Links — best for your standard packages

Stripe → **Payment Links** → make **one link per package**, once (e.g. "Full Session – \$70"). Text or email it to anyone and reuse it forever. **No extra fee** beyond normal card processing.



Invoices — for custom amounts or a formal bill

Stripe → **Invoices** → enter the customer's email + a line item → send. They get a **hosted invoice with a Pay button**, automatic reminders, and a PDF receipt. Costs a small **0.4%** per paid invoice on top of processing.

Which to use? **Payment Links** for your fixed session prices (cheaper and reusable). **Invoices** when you want a formal invoice, a due date, or a one-off custom amount. Either way the money lands in the **same Stripe balance and payouts** as your photo sales.